AMARI SMALLS

Virginia | 334-492-6413 | amarismalls589@gmail.com

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Research-focused economics graduate and current graduate student with experience reviewing evidence, synthesizing complex information, writing clear findings, and supporting research projects across economic development, public policy, and AI quality assurance. Strong communicator with client-facing and tutoring experience, skilled in desk research, source evaluation, presentation development, quality control, and turning research into accessible insights. Interested in qualitative consumer and cultural research.

EDUCATION

Old Dominion University — M.S. Data Science & Analytics, Business Intelligence & Analytics **Expected 2028**

Mary Baldwin University — B.A. Economics, Business Minor | GPA: 3.1 **May 2026**

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Incoming SEC Scholar | U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission (DERA) **Jan 2027 (expected)**

Washington, DC | On-site

- Tentatively selected for the SEC Scholars program in the Division of Economic and Risk Analysis.
- Anticipated work: supporting economic research, data review, and financial market analysis.

Economic Development Intern | City of Staunton Department of Economic Development **Jun–Aug 2025**

Staunton, VA

- Researched public records, zoning information, economic reports, and local development activity to support ongoing department projects.
- Reviewed more than 100 Enterprise Zone parcels, identified inconsistencies and trends, and organized findings for staff review.
- Prepared clear research summaries, visuals, and documentation that helped communicate findings across internal teams.
- Coordinated with staff across functions and maintained accurate project records under deadline.

Economic AI Intern | Outlier AI **Aug 2024–Jul 2025**

Remote

- Reviewed AI-generated economic analyses and research outputs for accuracy, logic, unsupported claims, and source-quality issues.
- Compared evidence across sources, flagged inconsistencies, and wrote concise feedback to improve the clarity and reliability of final outputs.
- Applied detailed quality-control standards independently in a remote, deadline-driven environment.

Research Contributor | PowerUp Initiative **Oct 2022–Aug 2024**

Remote / Project-Based

- Researched government publications, policy reports, academic literature, and public datasets related to economic mobility, workforce outcomes, and community issues.
- Synthesized findings from multiple sources into reports and presentation materials for nontechnical audiences.
- Compared sources for credibility and relevance and translated complex information into clear takeaways and recommendations.

Online Writing Tutor | Mary Baldwin University **Sep 2022–May 2026**

Remote

- Worked one-on-one with students to strengthen research papers, analytical writing, organization, evidence use, and clarity.
- Asked targeted questions to understand writers' goals, explained feedback clearly, and adapted support to different communication styles.
- Reviewed written work for logic, source integration, audience fit, and overall narrative consistency.

SELECTED RESEARCH & PROJECT EXPERIENCE

- Economic Mobility & Social Capital Analysis — examined research on mobility, community networks, and socioeconomic outcomes; synthesized evidence into written findings and presentations.
- Economics Capstone: Market Pricing & Consumer Demand — researched market behavior and consumer decision-making and communicated findings in a structured academic report.
- Public Policy & Government Research — evaluated government and policy sources, compared competing evidence, and summarized implications for written assignments and presentations.

SKILLS

Qualitative & Desk Research | Source Evaluation | Literature Reviews | Research Synthesis | Report Writing | Slide Development | Client & Stakeholder Communication | Meeting Documentation | Quality Control | Project Coordination | Microsoft Excel | PowerPoint | Word | Public Records Research | GIS/ArcGIS | Remote Collaboration